

Macro Three Replication Project: Investigating the Economic Impact of the CFA Franc Zone with Synthetic Control Methods

Callista Lodzinski, Mathilde Muller, and Elizabeth Schuck

Due: 29 May 2026

Test

1 Replication Target

In this project, we aim to replicate the findings of *From the French franc to the euro, is there an economic impact for the CFA franc zone countries? A 'bias-corrected' synthetic control method* by Alassane Diallo and Adama Ba, published in Cogent Economics & Finance in 2024. This paper assesses the impact of pegging the CFA franc to the euro on real GDP per capita in the West African Economic and Monetary Union (WAEMU) and the Central African Economic and Monetary Community (CAEMC) countries. The original study uses a set of 35 annual country-level panel data from 1980 to 2019 and applies synthetic control methods to estimate the counterfactual economic outcomes for member countries.

2 Data

Table 1: Variables

Variable	Type	Category	(First) Page Ref	Possible Source
Real GDP per capita	Continuous	Outcome	6	WDI, PennWorld
Lagged GDP per capita	Continuous	Lagged outcome	10	WDI, PennWorld
Gross Fixed Capital Formation (% GDP)	Continuous	Capital	10	
Government expenditure (% GDP)	Continuous	Fiscal	10	WDI, PennWorld
Official Development Assistance (% GDP)	Continuous	External	10	Source not listed
Foreign Development Investment (% GDP)	Continuous	External	10	WDI
Employment rate	Continuous	Labour	10	WDI
Agriculture (% GDP)	Continuous	Structure	10	WDI, PennWorld
Industry (% GDP)	Continuous	Structure	10	WDI, PennWorld
Governance / institutional quality	Index	Institutions	10	Polity5 Dataset
Political regime characteristics	Categorical/Index	Institutions	10	Polity5 Dataset
Inflation	Continuous	Macro controls	5	WDI, PennWorld
Euro peg dummy	Binary	Treatment		Authors
Synthetic GDP per capita	$\tilde{Y}_{it}$	Continuous	Constructed	
Treatment effect	τ_{it}	Continuous	Constructed	

Table 2: CFA franc zone countries annual inflation rate: WAEMU

country	1980–2001	2002–2021
Benin	7.5270	2.1268
Burkina Faso	4.3427	2.2660
Cote d’Ivoire	8.5558	2.1842
Guinea-Bissau	39.2343	2.8921
Mali	8.6642	3.5490
Niger	6.0235	2.8630
Senegal	5.1354	1.8448
Togo	6.2716	2.0069
Average inflation for the WAEMU zone	10.7193	2.4666
Average inflation without Guinea-Bissau	6.6457	2.4058

Table 3: CFA franc zone countries annual inflation rate: CAEMC

country	1980–2001	2002–2021
Cameroon	7.0840	1.8268
Central African Republic	6.5481	2.9430
Chad	5.2621	5.4660
Congo, Rep.	7.3655	6.1262
Equatorial Guinea	11.0392	6.7586
Gabon	7.4425	3.7486
Average inflation for the CAEMC zone	7.4569	4.4782

Table 4: Non-CFA franc zone countries mean annual inflation rate

country	1980–2001	2002–2021
Angola	550.9314	32.1383
Burundi	10.3255	9.2785
Congo, Dem. Rep.	1810.0588	16.3427
Ethiopia	4.8366	13.5134
Gambia, The	14.5303	10.1870
Ghana	36.1786	21.0285
Guinea	16.1342	11.2597
Kenya	11.8579	8.5152
Madagascar	18.4232	8.3332
Malawi	23.6956	18.1634
Nigeria	30.4076	13.5749
Sao Tome and Principe	31.6514	10.6113
Sierra Leone	51.3708	11.1235
Sudan	50.6410	38.3858
Tanzania	21.8489	7.4472
Uganda	53.1089	8.7408
Zambia	51.1202	12.4355
Zimbabwe	-1.6381	71.6617
Average inflation	154.7490	17.9300

Table 5: WAEMU countries' mean annual GDP per capita growth: PWT and WDI GDP variables

country	gdp_pc 1990-2001	gdp_pc 2002-2021	gdp_pc_wdi 1990-2001	gdp_pc_wdi 2002-2021
Benin	2.346	3.5210	6.6490	5.3990
Burkina Faso	2.128	2.1310	0.6550	6.7830
Cote d'Ivoire	-1.531	4.8070	2.7350	5.2180
Guinea-Bissau	1.117	0.3740	-3.7950	5.7200
Mali	6.151	3.0350	1.8710	5.8630
Niger	-0.662	0.6730	-0.0940	5.8740
Senegal	-0.167	0.7800	-1.3670	5.0240
Togo	-0.971	4.2710	-0.7730	4.8100
Average for the WAEMU area	1.051	2.4490	0.7350	5.5860
Average without Guinea-Bissau	1.042	2.7454	1.3823	5.5673

Table 6: CAEMC countries' mean annual GDP per capita growth: PWT and WDI GDP variables

country	gdp_pc 1990-2001	gdp_pc 2002-2021	gdp_pc_wdi 1990-2001	gdp_pc_wdi 2002-2021
Cameroon	-0.394	1.778	-0.893	4.667
Central African Republic	-1.317	0.249	-3.905	4.324
Chad	-0.920	3.472	-0.840	10.432
Congo, Rep.	2.000	5.218	0.293	7.294
Equatorial Guinea	20.730	5.369	26.017	10.281
Gabon	0.710	3.720	0.111	4.900
Average for the CAEMC zone	3.468	3.301	3.464	6.983

Table 7: Non-CFA countries' mean annual GDP per capita growth: PWT and WDI GDP variables

country	gdp_pc 1990-2001	gdp_pc 2002-2021	gdp_pc_wdi 1990-2001	gdp_pc_wdi 2002-2021
Angola	-1.080	7.569	-1.873	11.947
Burundi	-2.298	0.394	-3.251	3.790
Congo, Dem. Rep.	-9.217	3.809	13.317	8.093
Ethiopia	-0.458	8.390	-5.512	11.147
Gambia, The	0.116	-0.795	7.235	4.525
Ghana	0.871	3.227	-1.294	13.598
Guinea	-2.300	-0.454	-1.140	5.583
Kenya	-0.277	3.831	2.087	8.684
Madagascar	-0.579	1.062	2.322	2.806
Malawi	-1.973	2.291	2.170	7.383
Nigeria	2.047	10.405	9.192	9.814
Sao Tome and Principe	1.790	2.839	-1.862	8.234
Sierra Leone	-1.305	3.146	9.782	5.146
Sudan	1.158	4.018	6.773	3.877
Tanzania	1.438	3.720	4.056	5.696
Uganda	3.577	2.640	-0.793	7.755
Zambia	-0.045	5.263	-1.727	7.007
Zimbabwe	-1.315	0.359	-2.472	13.317
Average	-0.547	3.429	2.056	7.689